

APOORVA NIMSE

Jersey City, NJ-07306 | apoorva.nimse1111@gmail.com | +1 (848) 668-3974 | www.linkedin.com/in/apoorva-nimse

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Forward-thinking Food Science professional skilled in critical analysis, cross-functional collaboration, and innovation. Passionate about leveraging AI and sustainability to drive impact in dynamic roles.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Banza, New York, NY: Research and Development Technologist Aug 2025 – July 2026

- Owned 3 concurrent R&D innovation projects by leading benchwork, supporting R&D trial planning, and coordinating prototype testing from concept through execution.
- Increased benchtop testing efficiency by 80% by creating new internal product testing methods and standardized workflows.
- Built a prototype lab database management system with a full project brief to improve R&D documentation, traceability, and knowledge access.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with Consumer Insights, Quality, Operations, and external partners to troubleshoot product and process challenges, support plant trials, and translate benchtop learnings into scalable manufacturing solutions.

Cibo Vita, Totowa, NJ: Research and Development Intern Apr-May 2025

- Supported the Regulatory team in product labeling and compliance with FDA and industry standards.
- Coordinated cross-functional R&D projects, collaborating with QA, marketing, and operations to develop an interdepartmental project tracker.
- Led a project to develop an internal supplier document parser, streamlining the extraction of nutritional and product specification data for efficient company recordkeeping.

Sensory Science Laboratory, Rutgers University, NJ: Research Assistant Sept 2024-May 2025

- Led various academic and industry sensory evaluation projects.
- Teaching Assistant for “Wine Basics” and “Advanced Sensory Evaluation of Foods” courses, supporting over 30 students.

PepsiCo Global R&D, Valhalla, NY: Process Engineering Technician May-Aug 2024

- Executed benchtop experiments to rigorously assess and optimize ingredient functionality in beverage formulations, improving both product consistency and sensory appeal across current and future offerings.
- Partnered closely with Product Development, Flavorists, and Process Engineering teams to diagnose and resolve scale-up challenges encountered in concentrate plants.
- Leveraged lab-scale insights to develop practical, pilot-plant solutions that enhanced operational efficiency and product quality during production transitions.

Cross - Health is Wealth, India: Product Development Consultant (On Assignment) Jul-Aug 2023

- Designed a product range of unique nutraceutical OTS (Oral Thin Strips) strips made from seaweed.
- Evaluated products against quality standards and competitors' offerings, tracking production and progress to ensure timely completion of project deliverables.

WastED, Kolkata, India: Product Development Intern Jul 2022-Mar 2023

- Carried out research on Upcycled Brewers' Spent Grain and explored its applications as a sustainable ingredient across different verticals. Contributed to product prototype creation and testing and participated in designing processing schedules for mass production.
- Implemented a phased GTM (go-to-market) strategy for targeted marketing and sales, concurrently maintaining information for over 30 vendors in Excel to support negotiation.

AGF Ltd. Meat Processing, India: Student Intern Jul-Oct 2022

- Trained in Production and Quality Control and Assurance Departments. Oversaw plate freezing, cold storage, and packing operations and assisted in conducting quality audits and regular sample testing as part of quality control.
- Successfully reformulated frozen RTE meat spring rolls to address quality issues developing in storage. The extension of product shelf-life went from 1.5 months to nearly four, exceeding twice the initial duration.

- Ferrero India Pvt. Ltd., Baramati, India:** Production Intern Sep-Oct 2021
- Minimized waste generation in the Sorting area of TicTac Division, using different Quality Control tools including 5 New Why Analysis and Fishbone Diagrams.
 - Worked on a project to understand the effects of different processing conditions on sugar in TicTac. This contributed to increasing process efficiencies, particularly in the unit operation of panning.

EDUCATION

Rutgers University, New Brunswick, New Jersey Sep 2023-May 2025
Master of Science, Food Science
GPA: 3.95.

Relevant Coursework: *Basics of Artificial Intelligence for Science Professionals, Nutritional Aspects of Disease, Shelf-Life Testing, Sensory Evaluation of Foods, Intercolloidal Interface Science, Food Engineering Fundamentals, Food and Business Innovation.*

Master's Thesis (Critical Essay): Applications of Artificial Intelligence in Wine Making.
(Advisor – Dr. Mukund V. Karwe)

MIT Art, Design and Technology University, Pune, India 2019-2023
Bachelor of Technology, Food Technology

GPA: 3.96. **Gold Medallist** - Secured Highest GPA in Graduating Class of 121 Students

Relevant Coursework: *Techniques in Food Analysis, Food Microbiology, Food Quality Assurance and Certification, Food Packaging Technology, Introduction to Food Business Management, Food Product Development.*

Senior Project: Millitos – Multi-millet Curry Leaf Nachos

- Collaborated with a team of six students to create an innovative nacho chip product from a unique blend of millets, fortified with curry leaves.
- Led the development, including formulation, processing, cost analysis, shelf-life stability, marketing strategy, and successfully oversaw the sale of 250+ units with a 75% profit margin.

SKILLS

- Lab Experience – Chemical, Microbiology, Engineering
- Ingredient Research and Formulation
- Python and Artificial Intelligence – Beginner
- Sensory Evaluation and Testing – RedJade Software, XL Stat
- Food Regulation – Labelling, USDA Grades
- MS Office – PowerPoint, Excel, Word

AWARDS & ACHIEVEMENTS

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| 1. NYIFT Graduate Scholarship Award | 2025 |
| 2. Conducted session on “AI in Winemaking” at Symbiosis School of Culinary Arts, Pune | 2025 |
| 3. NAFFS Scholarship Award | 2024 |
| 4. Gold Medalist (B.Tech. Food Technology) | 2023 |
| 5. First Place in Poster Presentation Competition - National Conference hosted by MIT ADT University. | 2023 |
| 6. First Place in Debate Competition | 2023 |

PUBLICATIONS & CERTIFICATION

- **Publications -**
 - Millet Milk as a Dairy Alternative - PFND AI Food & Nutrition E-Magazine Feb 2023
 - Spirulina Farming: A Superfood - Food & Beverages Processing Magazine May 2022
- **Certifications -**
 - Fundamentals of AI & ML
 - MIT SMR - Adopting AI: Picking the Right Problems to Solve
 - Google Crash Course on Python
 - Craft Distillation Fundamentals
 - Beverage Production and Marketing
 - Food Allergy and Intolerance Training
 - Six Sigma White Belt